LIQUOR, DANCE, AND SOLILOQUY

I FELL ON MY BUTT, AND A CRICKET TURNS ART CRITIC

A cricket just jumped in my ear,

And I met it with equal reaction by flying off the couch.

Through the speaker,

Corinne Bailey Rae's asking me to let my hair down.

I found myself somewhere,

Somehow–on the floor.

It's a night like no other,

For once the lights in the sky outnumber the ones below,

And if I smoked cigarettes—which I don't,

It would be scenic.

Corinne, Jack Baileys, and a Backwood,

A Neo-abstract of the modern man.

I would face this painting,

And try to decipher it,

All the million meanings,

And just the one the artist had in mind.

Would I understand it even if they told me?

Oh there you are Mr. Cricket!

What's that?

You understand the portrait?

Chelsea Blakemore,

Is black man whimsy,

Faded denims, and greasy wifebeaters.

Hibiscus has a sweet tang,

Shows on my lips in purple stains,

If you dance well enough, you can taste it.

My heart is as bare and red as the press of the flower,

And my desire is to be as mental as Björk.

Known only to myself,

An eighth wonder of the world,

To captivate and never let go,

But the leash is long enough you'll believe you have it all,

So you'll chase it down,

Baileys in hand, and hard tar on your soles.

FOR A NIGHT OF DECADENCE

He’s a cigarette lit,

Struck up by a matchstick,

An attestation to his crude ways.

Buoyed up by a lily pad,

He sails down a scummy pond,

Assailed by Zephyr.

He’s a pillar of fire through the night,

And his foul stench stays the offenders.

His chantings are witchcraft reminiscent,

The smoky head he trails; Hecate’s torch.

They are wordings to lull the living,

More so to stir the asleep—

Reminders of their short fused life,

Raced down the wicker,

And so full of bicker,

And the debauchery wine brings.

Macallan, is that you?

Does the lifeboat yet be—